

STAGE NINE • ENGLISH VOCABULARY FIRST SET

FIRSTS

FAQ

Anticipated participant questions and suggested facilitator responses

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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Stage Nine • English Vocabulary First Set

PURPOSE

These are the questions that come up most often across cohorts of Stage Nine, with a suggested facilitator response for each. Several are specific to the genuine anxieties that come with language instruction — use these as a starting point, not a rigid script.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q1. What if English isn't my first language and I'm worried about my accent?

A: This stage is about precision and clarity of vocabulary, not accent or sounding like a native speaker. A clearly used, correctly chosen word in your own natural voice is exactly the goal — accent is not something this program evaluates or expects you to change.

Q2. What if I already know most of the words on a given list?

A: Wonderful — use the practice time to push into more complex, nuanced sentences than the basic examples, or help a partner who's finding a particular word newer. Fluency has real depth beyond just recognizing a word; use the extra time to build that depth.

Q3. Do I have to memorize every word on every list?

A: No. The goal is genuine, active use of a meaningful portion of each list, not perfect recall of all of it. Some words will become natural quickly; others may take longer or simply aren't as relevant to your specific field — that's completely fine.

Q4. What if I use a word incorrectly during a live practice exercise?

A: That's a completely normal, expected part of learning active vocabulary — it's actually the point of practicing out loud rather than just reading silently. Your facilitator will help correct it in the moment, and trying again right away is how it actually sticks.

Q5. Some of these idioms feel very culturally specific. Do I need to use them myself?

A: Not necessarily. For idioms specifically (FIRST M9), simply understanding them well enough to follow a conversation is a legitimate, sufficient goal. Using them yourself is a bonus, not a requirement, especially in cross-cultural or international settings where they may not translate clearly.

Q6. Why does Section 3's chapter order jump around instead of going in sequence?

A: That's intentional — the manual groups closely related vocabulary together (for example, both follow-up vocabulary sets sit near each other) rather than strictly by number. It's not an error; just follow the order in the Session Plan.